Swimming Champion Archie Goodburn to Deliver Rugby Match Ball in Front of 60,000 Fans

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Archie Goodburn is a champion swimmer from Edinburgh, Scotland. On Sunday, November 15, he will have a special job at a rugby game. He will carry the match ball onto the field before Scotland plays Australia at Murrayfield, in front of more than 60,000 fans.

Goodburn, who is 25, is a British champion and a European bronze **medallist**. He also holds the Scottish record for the 50-metre **breaststroke**. In 2024, doctors found that he had a rare brain **tumour**. After surgery, he worked hard and returned to competitive swimming. Now he also **campaigns** for better brain cancer treatment and research, and he has taken his campaign to Prime Minister Andy Burnham and to Scotland's First Minister, John Swinney. Fans at the game can also donate to two brain cancer charities.

Rugby is not new to him. He once played rugby at school, and at age 12 he sang a **solo** in front of 10,000 people. 'This means the absolute world to me,' he said.

Word Treasure

breaststroke -- A swimming stroke where you swim face-down and sweep your arms while kicking your legs.

tumour -- A lump that grows inside the body where it should not be, which can make a person very ill.

medallist -- An athlete who has won a medal at a big sports competition.

campaigns -- Works hard to speak up and push for a change, such as better treatment for an illness.

solo -- A song performed by just one singer on their own.

Background you need

Rugby teams sometimes invite a special guest to carry the match ball onto the field before a big game begins, which is a great honour. Archie Goodburn is a champion swimmer who became ill with a brain tumour, had surgery, and worked his way back to racing. He now speaks up for better brain cancer treatment and research, and fans at the game can give money to brain cancer charities.

Break it down

WHO: Archie Goodburn, a 25-year-old champion swimmer from Edinburgh, Scotland
WHAT: He will carry the match ball onto the field before Scotland's rugby game against Australia
WHERE: At Murrayfield, in front of more than 60,000 fans
WHY: To honour his return to swimming after brain tumour surgery and to support his campaign for better brain cancer treatment and research

Why it matters

It shows that even after a serious illness, you can work hard, get back to doing what you love, and use your story to help other people.

Test what you remember

1. Where is Archie Goodburn from?

- (A) London, England
- (B) Cardiff, Wales
- (C) Edinburgh, Scotland
- (D) Dublin, Ireland

2. What special job will Goodburn do at the rugby game?

- (A) Coach the Scotland team
- (B) Sing the national anthem
- (C) Referee the match
- (D) Carry the match ball onto the field

3. Which swimming record does Goodburn hold?

- (A) The European record for the 200-metre backstroke
- (B) The Scottish record for the 50-metre breaststroke
- (C) The British record for the 100-metre freestyle
- (D) The world record for the 50-metre butterfly

4. What did doctors find in 2024?

- (A) A rare brain tumour
- (B) A heart problem
- (C) A knee injury
- (D) A broken bone

5. What does Goodburn campaign for now?

- (A) Better brain cancer treatment and research
- (B) Longer school holidays
- (C) More swimming pools in Scotland
- (D) Cheaper rugby tickets for fans

6. What did Goodburn do when he was 12 years old?

- (A) He won his first swimming medal
- (B) He played rugby for Scotland's team
- (C) He started his brain cancer campaign
- (D) He sang a solo in front of 10,000 people

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: B 4: A 5: A 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Archie Goodburn: He says carrying the match ball means the absolute world to him.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):